

Hello from Seattle, where it's raining, because we sent this in December! We began our year with zero cats and have ended it, as you can see, with two Maine Coons named Frolic and Detour; they are seven months old and already bigger than Max (our dearly departed furball), and they'll grow for at least two more years. So they're, uh, tame lynxes. Afton continues to grow and develop and be wonderful. He keeps confounding all his happy doctors, who recently described him as "a singular child." That's one way of saying that he has preternatural spoken language comprehension but prefers to communicate in ASL. He has learned 200 signs so far and is fond of telling Mama and Dada that we need to learn more signs to keep up with him. Lindsey Controls the Seattle Opera as always ("pivot tables are my love language"), and Brendan does... whatever it is Brendan does, currently for a company called GitLab. This summer we decamped to a variety of state parks (including once with our ham radio friends in NR7WL), and then with the entire Narwhal Pincushion to ToorCamp ("rainy hacker Burning Man"), where Afton learned to request tacos from flying drones and, at one point, provide an incendiary device to Lindsey's boss. (It was fine! Don't worry! We're sort of like responsible parents!) We headed to Montana in December (with the cats) for a cousin reunion (now 6, 4, and 2) and are already planning new and exciting adventures (with the cats) in 2025. Given the political situation, non-trip time will be taken up with tax volunteering (Lindsey), Increasingly Extreme Lawyering (Brendan), and our Little Free Failure of Capitalism (all of us except the cats). As Afton goes to preschool (!) this year, we anticipate having the sniffles constantly, but we'd love visitors regardless.

In loving chaos,

**Afton, Lindsey, and Brendan O'Connor**  
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